

The Dhāraṇī Together with Mantras of the One Hundred and Eight Names of the Buddha, the Blessed One

Buddha Bhagavān Aṣṭaśatanāma Dhāraṇī · Toh 532 · Derge Kangyur

སངས་རྒྱལ་བཙལ་ལཱ་འདས་ཀྱི་མཆན་བརྒྱ་མརྒྱ་པ་གཟུངས་སྒྲས་དང་བཙས་པ།

Toh 532 in the Kangyur is a dhāraṇī text known in Sanskrit as the Buddha Bhagavān Aṣṭaśatanāma Dhāraṇī and in Tibetan as Sangs rgyas bcom ldan 'das kyi mtshan brgya rtsa brgyad pa gzungs sngags dang bcas pa, rendered in English as "The Dhāraṇī Together with Mantras of the One Hundred and Eight Names of the Buddha, the Blessed One." As its title indicates, the text belongs to the dhāraṇī genre and is devoted to enumerating one hundred and eight names and epithets of the Buddha, each reflecting an aspect of his enlightened qualities — his compassion, his physical majesty, his freedom from wrongdoing, and his perfection of wisdom — embedded within a framework of dhāraṇī and mantra recitation. Such name-dhāraṇī texts were widely used in Indian and Tibetan Buddhist practice as a means of generating merit, invoking the Buddha's blessings, and internalizing his qualities through liturgical recitation. It is classified among the dhāraṇī and mantra collections of the Kangyur, the Tibetan canon of translated Buddhist scriptures.

In the language of India: Buddha Bhagavān Aṣṭaśatanāma Dhāraṇī. In the language of Tibet: The Dhāraṇī Together with Mantras of the One Hundred and Eight Names of the Buddha, the Blessed One.

Homage to the Omniscient One.

Homage to the Blessed One, whose body is anointed with the fragrant sandalwood incense of compassion, whose lotus feet are touched by the jeweled crowns of gods and asuras (demigods), who is the self-arisen dispeller of darkness, the teacher who brings benefit to all the world — the Teacher, the Tathāgata, the Sage, free from all wrongdoing, whose very nature is peace, beautiful of form, resplendent with the brilliance of his clearly manifest major marks, adorned with the minor and major marks, possessed of all qualities in perfect completeness.

His face blooms like an opening lotus. His teeth are white, even, and closely set, abundantly full, luminous and beautiful as a flawless jewel, radiant and clear. Bright and gleaming, he blazes at the center of a vast radiance of

innumerable rays, like a thousand-rayed sun blazing with light, its maṇḍala overwhelming all with its splendor. Homage to the supreme Sage, endowed with the ten powers.

I bow down. I prostrate fully. I offer praise.

Oṃ bho hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Ā ā. Hī hī. Śiva śiva. Śānti śānti. Śama śama. Śamāpaya. Tathāgatānugata. Svabhāva. Abhāva. Samuttāya. Asamabala. Abīralabala. Amitābala. Atibala. Hūṃ ghuṃ ghuṃ. Dhro dhro. Bhrau bhrau. Bhredu bhredu. Hī hī. Bhagavān. Bhavānta kasurata bho ga mahāśāntikara. Pāpa kilpiṣa nāśaka svāhā.

Then, resplendent with the minor and major marks,
adorned in every limb,
brilliant as the sun,
possessing the ornament of the blazing maṇḍala,
renowned, utterly free from stain,
with a mind of Dharma, unstained and without fault,
the all-pervading great sovereign endowed with the ten powers,
glorious and free from dust —

upon the great jeweled ground,
at the summit palace, the vajra pinnacle,
where the sons of the Victor abide,
with many jewels radiantly gleaming,
and pure rays of light arrayed in clarity,
within the vajra maṇḍala palace,
upon the great field of the Sage's enjoyment,
he abides upon a vast and spacious lion throne.

Upon that very ground of jewel and substance,
upon that same vast and bright great throne,
the Tathāgata, with great joy,
is adorned and arrayed in perfect splendor —

the Sage, radiant with the light of fire, moon, and jewel,
brilliant with light that surpasses the rays of the sun,
in the manner of supreme ease and auspiciousness,
seated in the posture of luminous equipoise,
possessing a maṇḍala of blazing bodily light.

Through the expansion of clear light, the sovereign Sage
spreads forth immaculate rays of light —
this is called the Immovable One Possessed of the Vajra.

Having entered into the great maṇḍala,
those possessing the vajra, supremely disciplined,
having thoroughly purified all of that,
circumambulate the immaculate maṇḍala.

Having perfectly and completely purified
all the stains and impairments of the lower realms,
across the vast maṇḍala of the three existences,
shining clearly in many forms,
encompassing without exception all who move and all who do not move,
the great blissful Vajra-holder —

bearing the vajra sword,
enters within, crown unmoved.
Then, with the sound of a fearsome roar,
filling all, his eyes rolling as if reversed,
he who proclaims the awareness mantra Hūṃ,
the vajra terrifier, the one who strikes fear —
his beautiful face adorned with a smile,
his eyes, sinless, rolling wildly,
rises from his seat, prostrates,
makes excellent offerings, and declares:

"How wondrous! Destroyer of the extremes of birth,
dispeller of the stains of countless eons,
accomplisher of the qualities of awareness mantra —
this has been supremely proclaimed by the supreme Sages.

Beholding this, one obtains immeasurable virtue;
the wisdom of the buddhas becomes vast and expansive.
Even a bodhisattva of great wisdom,
practicing for a single eon,
could not finish rejoicing upon merely hearing
these qualities — fragrant with a hundredfold virtue —
from which all buddhas arise in an unbroken stream
and from which arise the many ways of practice.

Possessed of a vast ocean of enjoyment,
in the maṇḍala of the supreme awakening mind,
empowered by the supreme victors —"

Endowed with the qualities of non-regression, those who hear this and practice the conduct of the buddhas will, without exception, completely purify all the misdeeds of every sentient being. Their great minds will become entirely stainless. It pacifies, purifies, and bestows auspiciousness; it adorns with freedom from dust and brings peace. It is wholesome and dispels all sorrow; it definitively destroys all suffering. This supreme secret mantra that bestows power dispels all misdeeds upon the earth; it unfailingly grants the fruit that is beyond reproach; it is a teaching that tames aversion; it dispels transgressions that have been committed.

Whoever hears this dhāraṇī — even the attainment of buddhahood, difficult as it is to obtain, will be reached without long delay. All obscurations are completely pacified; it is the all-pervading lord that clears away every affliction. Whoever keeps this dhāraṇī — the one that pacifies afflictions — will attain Samantabhadra himself and likewise Vajrapāṇi himself. The lord of vidyā-mantra holders too will be attained by hearing this.

Brilliant throughout all worlds, the Blessed One Vairocana himself — the supreme and fathomless maṇḍala — until this very teaching is heard, the self-arisen rank that tames and utterly pacifies afflictions has not yet been gained. But once it is heard for the sake of complete purification, one is purified the very moment of hearing it. Therefore, those who wish for excellence and what is good should recite this sūtra of words. This supreme dhāraṇī proclaimed by the Victor, for the purpose of exhausting afflictions — whoever hears it and thereby abandons their misdeeds, committing evil no more, hating what is wholesome no longer, utterly turning away from the nature of evil — to them I shall appear in direct vision. Let no further evil be committed, and let all former misdeeds be confessed. Through the power and strength of this supreme dhāraṇī, all misdeeds without exception will be purified. Whatever non-virtuous and unwholesome actions were committed in a thousand other lifetimes, or even in ten billion lifetimes, will be purified — of this there is no doubt.

On the eighth day of the waxing moon and likewise on the fifteenth, one should diligently undertake the observance of the precepts and make offerings to the buddhas according to the proper rite. Thereafter, free from confusion,

one will decisively vanquish the enemy of afflictions; and by reciting this incomparable and supremely difficult-to-maintain dhāraṇī that repels transgressions, one will assuredly behold the radiance of the moon from the Teacher's own face blazing forth. Then, having completed the two accumulations, one will become a true son of the Victors, gloriously adorned with the boundless qualities belonging to the domain of Amitābha, and will attain what is unfathomable even across ten billion eons.

Then, upon hearing the words of Vajrapāṇi, the beings dwelling in the maṇḍalas rose up with a great stir, their bodies adorned with jeweled shoulder ornaments, earrings, and all manner of ornaments swaying and flashing, and they presented the Blessed One with a great variety of offerings. The holders of awareness mantras dwelling on Mount Kailāsa and on Mount Meru, and likewise the holders of awareness mantras assembled in the great maṇḍala, and those dwelling on the Malaya mountain range bearing blazing ornaments, and Viṣṇu, the Great God (Śiva), and the other lords of the gods, and Vajrapāṇi and the other great powerful bodhisattvas — all of them, stirring and rising, their bodies radiant with jeweled armlets and earrings and swaying ornaments, paid homage with palms joined to the Victor, the lord who is free from all misdeeds. Together they praised that supreme and noble Sage, the lord of all the earth, with one hundred and eight names.

Equal in nature, suchness of phenomena,
Utterly lucid in realization, blazing bright.
Tamed, steadfast, dispeller of all stains,
Unstained, flawless, free from all defect.

The Sage, the buddha, supremely tranquil,
Protector of the world, lord of all born beings.
The Tathāgata who has subdued the afflictions,
Likewise the Victor who has swept away the dust.

The Teacher who teaches, firm and unwavering,
Without wrongdoing, parted from all dust.
The protector of the world who bestows radiance,
Pure and peaceful, son of immaculate sustenance.

Who has utterly vanquished the afflictions and brings benefit,
The Teacher who dispels all stain.
Whose conduct is spotless, his way excellent,
Firm, thoroughly victorious over the profound.

Mighty, his compassion fully triumphant,
The Protector who likewise acts as protector.
His very nature peace, free from aversion,
Freed from bondage, definitively liberated.

The supreme of all the world, ground of the variegated,
Who does not grasp at self, unstained.
Dispeller of afflictions, possessed of glory,
Who creates splendor, who likewise creates benefit.

Incomparable, without peer or parallel,
All-pervading lord who abandons afflictions and actions.
Free from conceit, without the lowly,
Equal, and yet equal to the unequal.

Who has attained radiance, without need to illuminate,
Light-giver to the world, free from wrongdoing.
Who has abandoned all obscurations,
Striving to benefit all the world.

The hero, peaceful, maker of peace,
Who has exhausted the enemy-afflictions.
Master who knows skillful means, of great skillful means,
The very ground of all sentient beings.

Meaningful, difficult to find, endowed with intelligence,
Difficult to overpower within the vajra maṇḍala.
The Protector, dispeller of fear, Brahmā,
Likewise the buddha who upholds the Dharma.

The great hero, without fear,
Of beautiful form, his marks resplendent.
Endowed with the thirty-two marks,
An ocean of the enjoyment of Dharma.

Adorned with the eighty excellent minor marks,
His very being displaying wonders in his ornate form.
Teacher of the effortless,
Who likewise satisfies and bestows happiness.

Powerful, vast, and far-reaching,
Who dispels the powers of the four māras.
Of great diligence, of great enthusiasm,

Of great joy, of great strength.

Who has attained power, greatly firm,
Dwelling in a place of power, flourishing by his might.
Radiant, possessed of speech, without parallel,
Virtuous, victorious through emptiness.

Supremely tranquil, free from darkness,
Of great intelligence, upholder of Dharma.
Fully endowed with excellent qualities, having attained the great ground,
Who tames desires.

Creator of splendor, possessor of splendor, endowed with splendor,
Of gloriously expansive enjoyment and richness.
The Blessed One who shares and causes to be shared,
Possessed of voice, auspicious, abode of the Victor.

Equal, knower of equality,
Of immeasurable characteristics of equality.
Supremely joyful, with clear enjoyment,
Well-founded, with equanimous mind.

Of pure intellect, endowed with intelligence, free from stains,
Dwelling in the great place with great firmness.
Of expansive enjoyment, without stain,
The Sage adorned with the ornament of compassion.

Of good fortune, refuge from fear,
Likewise fearless, dispeller of afflictions.
Stainless, free from defects, endowed with enjoyment,
Beautified by a maṇḍala of variegated radiance.

Of beautiful form, the supreme sequence of virtue,
Endowed with the radiance of compassion, of beautiful light.
Non-abiding, of supreme noble enjoyment,
The cause of Dharma, abiding place of qualities.

Worthy of reverence, supreme abiding, of great enjoyment,
Sky-marked, of pure intellect.
Like a precious image, auspicious,
Supreme goose, wide-eyed, lotus-eyed.

The Victor, dispeller of faults, endowed with wisdom,
Possessed of wisdom and skillful means.
Transcending all non-virtue in the world,
Endowed with pure enjoyment and steadfastness.

Possessing the grounds, the powers, and the wisdoms of patience,
Endowed with all perfections.
Who fully enjoys meditative absorption,
Directly present at the gateways of liberation.

In generosity equal to all buddhas,
The great Dharma arising in happiness.
Transcending the domain of omniscience,
Without obscuration in the sphere of activity.

Victor among the faculties of bodhisattvas,
The sacred aim, of great manner.
In all domains of what is to be known,
Having attained appearance without obscuration.

Born in accord with the great lineage,
The abode of virtue of the Tathāgata.
Having attained distinction, having attained equality,
Unequaled, yet equal to all buddhas.

The great aim brought to its uttermost fulfillment,
Free of affliction — hard to master.
The ascetic purifier who purifies wrongdoing,
Who brings to happiness without harm.

Of vast mind, omniscient,
Having heard without remainder the weapons of learning.
The rare one who comes to attain happiness,
Endowed with the domain of equality and distinction.

The protector who spreads throughout all worlds,
The weapon of calm abiding — hard to master.
The domain of the inconceivable and the immeasurable,
Incomparable, yet serving as a comparison.

Possessed of splendor, of radiant light and great joy,
Well-spoken, arising through the power of mind.
The wise one of beautiful countenance who bestows happiness,

Whose domain of conduct transcends all joy.

Of great speech and great gnosis,
Of great abode and great auspiciousness.
Worthy of offering, transcending every domain,
Free of the characteristic marks of action.

Born in the buddha realm,
Vast in the domain of what is to be known.
Omniscient, possessed of the fruit of enjoyment,
Whose domain transcends the power of the world.

The illumination of the domain of omniscience,
Endowed with abundant and perfect skillful means.
Possessed of the means of miraculous display,
Teacher of the way of the dance of Dharma.

Supremely demonstrating, the master of qualities,
Who tames all conduct without remainder.
Thoroughly complete, utterly pure,
Fully awakened to the domain of buddhas.

Who has overcome obstacles and wrongdoing,
Who has dispelled the arrogance of māra.
Having gained complete victory on the field of battle,
A great hero of undefeatable strength.

Who has mounted the chariot of the Great Vehicle,
Of vast mind difficult to challenge,
Who has crossed to the far shore of the ocean of afflictions.
Abiding in the ways of the Great Vehicle,

Enjoying the supreme vehicle,
Whose domain transcends that of the śrāvakas,
And who has gone beyond even the pratyekabuddhas.
Abiding in the fruit of the buddha ground,

Who knows what is ever more and more distinguished.
You abide in a celestial dwelling,
Enjoying the great oceans
Of the grounds and realms that are the source of happiness.

Having praised the sovereign among buddhas, the fully flourishing one, with one hundred and eight names, the assembled gods and others, bowing down with heads to the ground, took their places facing him in one direction.

Then, within the great maṇḍala, all who were present settled into deep and complete stillness. The one whose crown was bound with a vajra-crown ornament arose, and the crown jewel shook greatly. Throughout all the elevated places of the maṇḍala, a great tumultuous sound filled everything entirely. The jeweled ornaments swayed and trembled, and the sound of "Ha Ha!" rang out, as they declared:

"Wondrous! Great are the qualities of the buddha, accumulated through three immeasurable eons. The bodhicitta and the other supreme ones have well recited the one hundred and eight names.

"Wondrous! It is gain and the arising of happiness. Even having heard the one hundred and eight names, whoever reads them and praises the Victor shall come to attain great fruit.

"If one recites before the Blessed One the one hundred and eight names together with their mantra, one attains purification of all obscurations, all accumulated defilements, and all wrongdoing.

"If one recites aloud the supreme one hundred and eight names, one is definitively liberated from all obscurations, abandons all afflictions entirely, and becomes great wisdom itself.

"That one shall not fall away from great prosperity and happiness. That one, in all their lifetimes, being intelligent, shall remember their past lives.

"Then the Blessed One, Victor over māra, looking directly upon that son of boundless qualities whose crown was bound with a vajra-crown ornament, declared:

"This ground of the Victor is peace, vanquishing afflictions such as pride. Transcending all worldly happiness, it draws near to the happiness of the Tathāgata.

"Those who listen to the dhāraṇī and the one hundred and eight names, which others cannot fathom — those ones are of pure nature and wish for the happiness of all sentient beings. By merely hearing them once, those ones abide in the fruit of the great ground. If before long they are to rejoice —"

"What need is there to speak of those who bear it and the rest? Therefore, with continuous and thorough effort, those who desire happiness forever should listen to this dhāraṇī endowed with an ocean of qualities, and bear it in mind. Whoever rises in the morning and recites it, or recites it from their own lips — all their aims will be accomplished, and they will never meet with harm.

"This is a vessel of all virtues, bestowing an abundance of wholesome qualities, the supreme fruit of unsurpassed omniscience, and the means by which one attains the source of happiness. Whatever fruit one desires, there is no doubt that it will be obtained. Having attained the rank of omniscience, one will proceed to the incomparable abode.

"It is virtuous and endowed with fruit; it bestows the fruit of the buddhas' grounds; it is pleasant and possessed of qualities; it bestows compassion unstained by defilement. This is the sūtra of equality, the joy that pervades all the world — from it arises the happiness of all the world, and there is nothing whatsoever comparable to it. The Teacher, the Blessed One, the buddha —"

Translator's Notes

- The mantra passage is a phonetic transcription of a Sanskrit dhāraṇī and is rendered as-is without translation of its syllables, as is standard practice for mantra literature.

The phrase rendered "destroyer of the extremes of birth" translates a term meaning one who conquers or overcomes the directions or sides of birth and death, a common epithet pointing to transcendence of cyclic existence. The Tibetan "skye ba'i phyogs 'joms" is here translated according to its doctrinal sense.

The final verse section ends mid-sentence in the source passage, suggesting this is an excerpt. The translation reflects that open ending faithfully.

- The phrase rendered "the lord of vidyā-mantra holders" translates a title indicating the supreme master or sovereign of those who hold awareness mantras; this is a recognized tantric epithet, likely referring to a buddha or the principal deity of the relevant transmission.

The phrase "the moon from the Teacher's own face blazing forth" renders a poetic image of the Teacher's face as a moon from which light blazes; the exact visual or ritual referent may belong to a specific iconographic context not fully recoverable from the text alone.

"Viṣṇu, the Great God (Śiva)" renders Khyab-'jug (Viṣṇu) and Lha-chen (Mahādeva / Śiva) as two distinct named deities listed in sequence, which is the natural reading of the Tibetan.

- The phrase rendered "son of immaculate sustenance" translates "zas gtsang sras," literally "son of pure food." This likely carries a specific doctrinal or epithetic resonance pointing to the Buddha's spiritual lineage or nature rather than a biographical reference; the rendering preserves the literal sense.

The epithet "sky-marked" renders "nam mkha' mtshan te," meaning one whose characteristic is like space — vast, pure, and unobstructed — and is here given literally as it forms part of a sequence of image-epithets.

The phrase "equal to the unequal" renders "mi mnyam mnyam," a classical formula indicating that while the Buddha is equal in the sense of equanimity, he is also uniquely equal in a way that transcends ordinary comparison — a standard paradox of buddha-praise literature.

- The passage concludes mid-sentence, which reflects an incomplete portion of the source text as presented. The final line "□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□" is a conditional clause whose apodosis is missing; the translation renders it accordingly as an open conditional.

The phrase "सर्वज्ञः सर्वभूतहिते रतः" literally means "the one whose head is bound with a vajra-crown" or "vajra-diadem." This refers to a bodhisattva figure wearing a vajra-crown, likely Vajrapāṇi or a similar figure; the text does not name him explicitly but calls him "that son" (पुत्रः) of boundless qualities.

The expression "𑀧𑁆𑀭𑀢𑀺𑀓𑀲𑀸𑀣𑀻𑀗𑀼𑀩𑀤𑀳𑀾𑀫𑀮𑀿𑀇" ("the weapon of calm abiding") is an unusual construction. It appears to praise the subject as wielding calm abiding with the force of a weapon — a vivid metaphor for the power of śamatha.

- The passage breaks off mid-sentence at the end, consistent with the provided continuation structure. The phrase rendered "rises in the morning" translates the adverb meaning "having arisen at dawn" and frames the recitation as an early-morning practice. "The incomparable abode" renders "peerless place," a standard epithet for nirvāṇa or the buddha-realm. The phrase "sūtra of equality" likely refers to this very text being described as the "sameness sūtra," possibly reflecting a title or doctrinal category; no significant uncertainty, but worth noting for editorial context.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.